

Bryn Mawr College
ISNT 100: Fundamental of Economics for International
Studies
Fall Semester 2026

Contact Information:

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Office hours: Tuesdays and Thursdays: 12:15 to 1:15 pm

This syllabus provides a general plan for the course; deviations may be necessary.

Course Objective:

This course provides an introduction to economic concepts, methodologies, and analytical frameworks relevant to international studies. The course focuses on developing students' ability to understand, interpret, and critically evaluate economic data and analysis in both scholarly research and mass media. The aim is to give students solid understanding of and competency in evaluating the approaches to and uses/applications of economic data and analysis in mass media and scholarly research intended for general audiences.

The course does not assume prior economics coursework and does not presume students will proceed to higher level Economics courses (for which they would still need to earn a merit grade in Econ 105).

Textbooks and Resources:

- *Issues in Economics Today* 10th Edition, Robert C. Guell - **Main textbook**
- *Principles of Economics* 9th Edition, Gregory Mankiw - **Additional resources**
- *Principles of Economics* 3rd Edition, openstax [Link](#) - **Additional resources**

Course Requirements:

The course requirements include homework assignments, two in-class exams, short writing assignments, class participation, and a final policy article.

Component	Date	Share in total grade
Exam 1	October 8	30%
Exam 2	November 19	30%
Homework		15%
Class participation		5%
Microeconomics Writing	September 18 & October 23	7.5%
Macroeconomics Writing	November 6 & December 4	7.5%
Final Paper	December 18, 12 pm	5%

All four writing assignments are due at **11:59 pm on a Friday**. The final policy article is due at **12 pm on Friday, December 18**, the date set by the College for our final exam period. Class participation includes attendance, in-class quizzes and worksheets, the written assignment set in lieu of class on November 24, and the final presentations on December 10.

Grading scale: Scores below are percentages. Grades of 2.0 and above are *merit* grades; 1.7 and below are *below merit*.

Grade	4.0	3.7	3.3	3.0	2.7	2.3	2.0	1.7	1.3	1.0	0.0
Score	95–100	90–94	87–89	83–86	80–82	77–79	73–76	70–72	67–69	63–66	<63

Homework

There will be homework assignments over the semester. Homework will be due no less than one week after they are assigned. You must turn in your own work, but group effort is permitted and encouraged. Homework turned in late after the due date will be docked 10 percentage points every 24 hours. After 5 days late, the maximum possible grade will be 50% of the full points.

Economic Analysis Assignments

Throughout the semester, students will complete five writing assignments that apply economic concepts to contemporary issues around the world. The assignments are divided between microeconomics and macroeconomics and conclude with a final policy article that integrates material from the course. Each is one to two pages and must include a graph and cited sources.

Microeconomics Assignments: The first two assignments examine current economic events through the lens of microeconomic theory. You will analyze recent news articles using concepts such as supply and demand, elasticity, comparative advantage, and externalities. Each assignment requires students to explain the underlying economic mechanisms, support their analysis with appropriate graphs, and evaluate the implications for markets and economic welfare. **Due September 18 and October 23.**

Macroeconomics Assignments: The next two assignments focus on macroeconomic analysis using publicly available data from sources such as *Our World in Data*, the World Bank, and the International Monetary Fund. You will examine a global economic challenge and a macroeconomic indicator, interpret trends in the data, connect them to macroeconomic models covered in class, and evaluate policy responses using economic reasoning. Both open on October 29 and run in parallel. **Due November 6 and December 4.**

Final Policy Article: The final assignment is an evidence-based policy article written for a general audience. You will choose an economic issue of interest, draw on the analysis conducted in your previous assignments, and develop a policy recommendation supported by economic theory, empirical evidence, and data visualizations. You will present the argument in class on December 10. **Due December 18 at 12 pm.**

Disability Support Services: Reasonable Accommodations

Bryn Mawr College is committed to providing equal access to students with a documented disability. Students needing academic accommodations for a disability must first register with Access Services. Students can call 610-526-7516 to make an appointment with the Director of Access Services, Deb Alder, or email her at dalder@brynmawr.edu to begin this confidential process. Once registered, students should schedule an appointment with the professor as early in the semester as possible to share the verification form and make appropriate arrangements. Please note that accommodations are not retroactive and require advance notice to implement. More information can be obtained at the Access Services website. (<http://www.brynmawr.edu/access-services/>)

Any student who has a disability-related need to record this class first must speak with the Director of Access Services and to me, the instructor. Class members need to be aware that this class may be recorded.

Academic Honesty

Students are responsible for knowing and adhering to the Bryn Mawr Honor Code. If you have any questions about expectations, please ask.

Title IX:

Bryn Mawr/Haverford College is committed to fostering a safe and inclusive living and learning environment where all can feel secure and free from harassment. All forms of sexual misconduct, including sexual assault, sexual harassment, stalking, domestic violence, and dating violence are violations of Bryn Mawr/Haverford's policies, whether they occur on or off campus. Bryn Mawr/Haverford faculty are committed to helping to create a safe learning environment for all students and for the College community as a whole. If you have experienced any form of gender or sex-based discrimination, harassment, or violence, know that help and support are available. Staff members are trained to support students in navigating campus life, accessing health and counseling services, providing academic and housing accommodations, and more.

The College strongly encourages all students to report any incidents of sexual misconduct. Please be aware that all Bryn Mawr/Haverford employees (other than those designated as confidential resources such as counselors, clergy, and healthcare providers) are required to report information about such discrimination and harassment to the Bi-College Title IX Coordinator.

Information about the College's Sexual Misconduct policy, reporting options, and a list of campus and local resources can be found on the College's website:

Bryn Mawr Sexual Misconduct Policy · Haverford Sexual Misconduct Policy

Tentative course outline:

Date	Topic	Chapter	Chapter
		Main Text	Additional Text
Tuesday, September 1, 2026	What is Economics?	1	1
Thursday, September 3, 2026	Demand and Supply Analysis	2	4
Tuesday, September 8, 2026	Market Equilibrium, Shifts, Movement	2	4,7
Thursday, September 10, 2026	Elasticity and Total Revenue	3	5
Tuesday, September 15, 2026	DWL, Welfare, Tariffs and Taxes	3	6
Thursday, September 17, 2026	Perfect Competition and Monopoly	4	
Tuesday, September 22, 2026	Rationale for Trade – PPF and Ricardo	17	
Thursday, September 24, 2026	Rationale for Trade – PPF and Ricardo	17	
Tuesday, September 29, 2026	Game Theory and Strategic Interactions		10
Thursday, October 1, 2026	Market Failures: Externalities, Public Goods, CPR		11
Tuesday, October 6, 2026	Review		
Thursday, October 8, 2026	Midterm Exam 1		
Tuesday, October 13, 2026	Fall Break – No Class		
Thursday, October 15, 2026	Fall Break – No Class		
Tuesday, October 20, 2026	GDP, Inflation, Unemployment	6	23,24,28
Thursday, October 22, 2026	GDP, Inflation, Unemployment	6	23,24,28
Tuesday, October 27, 2026	Money and the Role of the Federal Reserve	10	29
Thursday, October 29, 2026	Federal Reserve continued	10	30
Tuesday, November 3, 2026	Aggregate Demand and Aggregate Supply	8	33
Thursday, November 5, 2026	Fiscal and Monetary Policy	9	34
Tuesday, November 10, 2026	Fiscal and Monetary Policy	9	34
Thursday, November 12, 2026	Exchange Rate	18	
Tuesday, November 17, 2026	Review		
Thursday, November 19, 2026	Midterm Exam 2		
Tuesday, November 24, 2026	No Class – Policies in a Globalized World (written assignment)		
Thursday, November 26, 2026	Thanksgiving Break – No Class		
Tuesday, December 1, 2026	Inequality	31,38	
Thursday, December 3, 2026	Colonialism and Long-run Impacts		
Tuesday, December 8, 2026	Colonialism and Long-run Impacts		
Thursday, December 10, 2026	Presentations		